

SESSION 3 — FOOT SPEED

60 minutes · footwork bias · high nervous-system cost · needs a jump rope, eight cones, a flat 15 m strip

Turnover, ground-contact time, and clean mechanics at speeds that are slightly uncomfortable. Every work interval here is 45 seconds or shorter, because foot speed trained past fatigue is just footwork practice done badly.

Run this session fresh. If the legs are heavy from yesterday, run session 2 or 6 instead and come back to this one.

Marker for the log: number of complete advance–retreat cycles in the 20-second round 1 burst of block B, counted the same way every time.

Stop rule: when the count in a 20-second burst falls more than 15% below your best of the day, the block is over.

Minute by minute



TIME	BLOCK	WORK AND REST
0:00–0:04	Raise	2 min jog, 2 min easy rope · easy throughout
0:04–0:08	Mobility	Ankles and calves, four movements · easy throughout
0:08–0:12	Activation	Marches, skips, wall drill, quick feet · continuous work
0:12–0:22	A — Rope and footwork	5 rounds of 2 min · 40 s work / 20 s rest, twice a round
0:22–0:32	B — Strip bursts	10 rounds on the minute · 20 s work / 40 s rest
0:32–0:40	C — Cone ladder	8 rounds on the minute · 20 s work / 40 s rest
0:40–0:50	D — Fencing transfer	5 rounds of 2 min · 30 s work / 90 s rest
0:50–0:56	Finisher	Called direction changes, 6 rounds · 30 s work / 30 s rest
0:56–1:00	Cool-down	Calves and feet · easy throughout

0:00–0:04 · Raise

Easy throughout

Two minutes of easy jogging, then two minutes of relaxed rope: 40 s skipping, 20 s rest, three times. No speed yet. The rope is here to wake the ankles up.

0:04–0:08 · Mobility

Easy throughout

1. **Ankle circles**, 15 each direction each foot, then 15 point-and-flex.
2. **Calf and soleus stretch** against the post, 45 s each — straight leg first, then the same stretch with the knee bent.
3. **Deep squat hold**, 45 s, rocking the knees forward over the toes.
4. **Toe yoga**, 30 s each foot: lift the big toe alone, then the other four alone. It will be terrible the first few sessions. It gets better.

0:08–0:12 · Activation

Continuous work

- **A-march**, 20 m. Tall, knee to hip height, foot landing under the hip.
- **A-skip**, 20 m, same shape with a bounce.
- **Wall drill**, 3 × 15 s. Lean into the post at a hard angle, drive alternate knees fast without the hips sagging.
- **Quick feet in place**, 3 × 10 s, tiny and fast, on the balls of the feet.

0:12–0:22 · Block A — Rope and footwork alternating



10 × 40 s work / 20 s rest

Five rounds of two minutes: 40 s rope, 20 s rest, 40 s footwork, 20 s rest. Rotate the rope variation each round, and keep the footwork the same throughout so the change in your own speed is visible.

ROUND	ROPE, 40 S	FOOTWORK, 40 S
1	Two-foot bounce	Small fast advance-retreat
2	Alternating single-leg	Small fast advance-retreat
3	High-knee rope	Small fast advance-retreat
4	Crossover	Small fast advance-retreat
5	Fast singles or double-unders	Small fast advance-retreat

The footwork here is deliberately small — half your normal step length, twice your normal frequency, en garde never breaking.

0:22–0:32 · Block B — Strip bursts



10 × 20 s work / 40 s rest

Ten rounds of one minute: 20 seconds at full speed, 40 seconds walking back and resetting. A different pattern each round.

ROUND	PATTERN
1	Advance-retreat, maximum clean frequency — count the cycles, this is the marker
2	Double advance, double retreat
3	Check-step: advance with a half-step pause, then finish
4	Patinando — small appel-step then advance
5	Cross-step forward and back (épée; saber fencers do double advances instead)
6	Retreat, lunge, recover backward
7	Bouncing in place with direction calls from a partner or a random-number app
8	Advance, advance, lunge
9	Retreat, retreat, explosive jump forward
10	Free footwork — whatever you are worst at

Count round 1 out loud or film it on a propped phone. The count only means anything if it is counted the same way every week.

0:32–0:40 · Block C — Cone ladder



8 × 20 s work / 40 s rest

Lay seven cones in a straight line about 40 cm apart: the gaps between them are your six rungs. Eight rounds of one minute: roughly 20 seconds of pattern, then walk back and reset. One pattern per round. With fewer cones, use four rungs and run the pattern twice.

1. One foot per gap, forward
2. Two feet per gap, forward
3. Two feet per gap, moving laterally
4. In-in-out-out
5. Ali shuffle — one foot in, one out, switching
6. Hopscotch
7. Single-leg hops through, three gaps per leg
8. Scissors, facing sideways

Eyes up on every pattern. Looking at your feet is the habit this block is meant to break.

0:40–0:50 · Block D — Fencing transfer



5 × 30 s work / 90 s rest

Five rounds of two minutes: 30 seconds of work, 90 seconds of rest.

Set a cone at your own lunge distance from the post and pick a small target on the post at chest height. From en garde with your front foot at the cone, perform advance-lunges at the fastest speed that still lands the point on the target and still recovers to a balanced en garde. Count the clean ones; a lunge that misses the target does not count.

Alternate the lead foot between rounds if both weapons are trained. If not, use rounds 3 and 5 for retreat-lunges instead.

0:50–0:56 · Finisher — called changes



6 × 30 s work / 30 s rest

Six rounds: 30 seconds on, 30 seconds off. A partner calls "forward", "back", "lunge" and "hold" at random; alone, use a random-number app on a 2-second beep with a number mapped to each action. Full en garde throughout, nothing sloppy allowed because it is the end of the session.

0:56–1:00 · Cool-down



Easy throughout

Walk 60 s. Roll each foot over a ball or a water bottle for 45 s. Calf stretch 30 s each side. Quad stretch 30 s each side. Finish sitting, shoes off, toes spread, four slow breaths.

Log line

date · 03 foot speed · who · surface · round-1 cycles __ · clean advance-lunges __ · felt _/10